

Drosophila Dual-Goal Steering Madness

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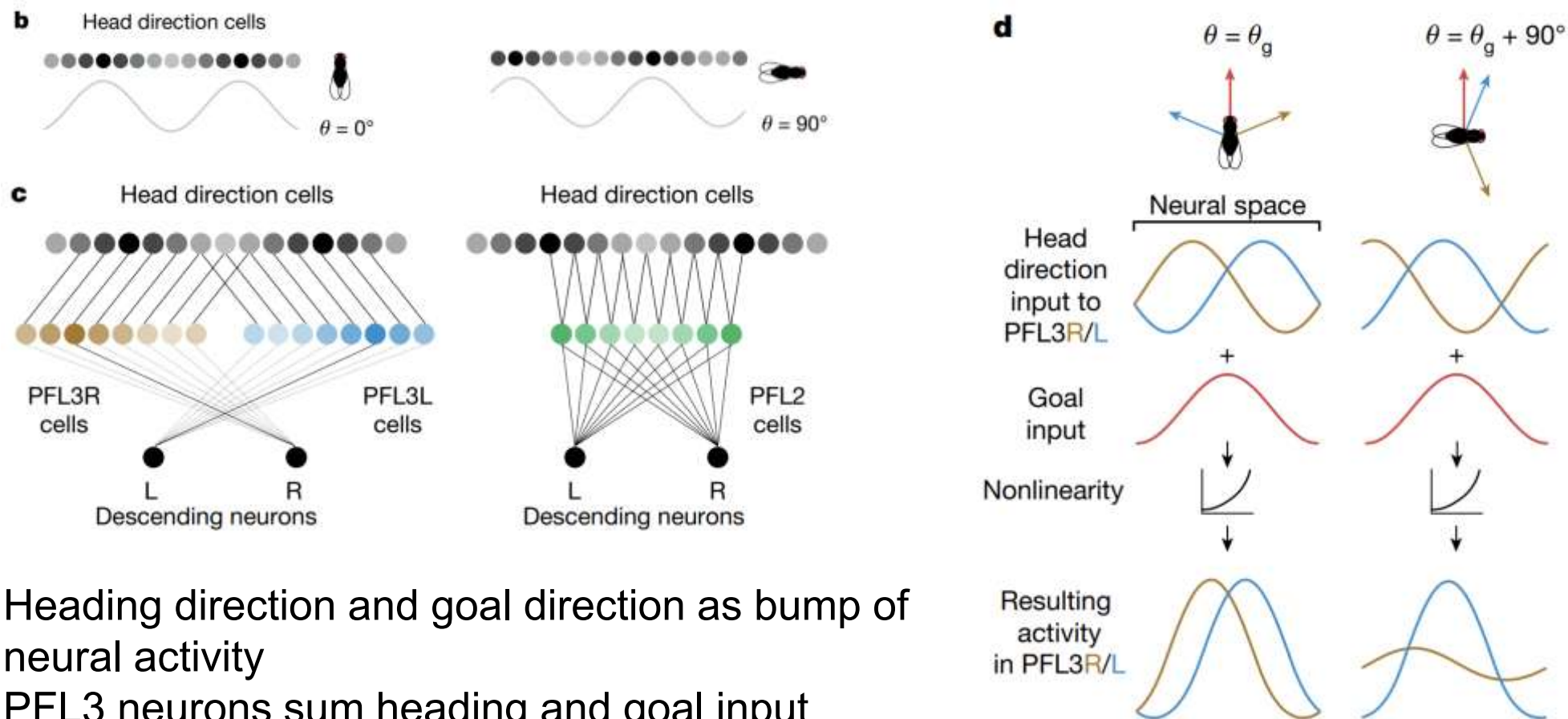
MAE 541

2026.05





The Central Complex Steering Circuit



- Heading direction and goal direction as bump of neural activity
- PFL3 neurons sum heading and goal input
- Difference between sum of left and right PFL activity determines steering command



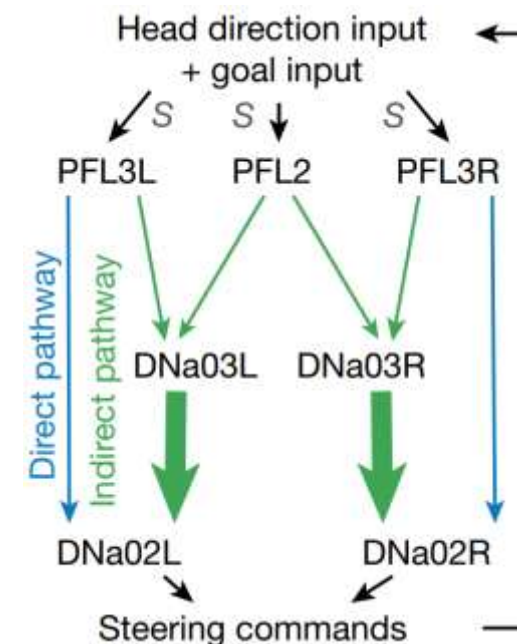
The Full Circuit Model

- Heading direction and goal direction as bump of neural activity
- PFL3 neurons sum heading and goal input

$$\begin{aligned} \text{PFL2} &= f(S \times (\cos(\theta - \theta_0 - \mathbf{h} + 180^\circ) + A \times \cos(\theta_g - \theta_0 - \mathbf{h}))) \\ \text{PFL3R} &= f(S \times (\cos(\theta - \theta_0 - \mathbf{h} + 67.5^\circ) + A \times \cos(\theta_g - \theta_0 - \mathbf{h}))) \\ \text{PFL3L} &= f(S \times (\cos(\theta - \theta_0 - \mathbf{h} - 67.5^\circ) + A \times \cos(\theta_g - \theta_0 - \mathbf{h}))) \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{ELU}(M) = M \text{ for } M \geq 0$$

$$\text{ELU}(M) = e^M - 1 \text{ for } M < 0$$



- Different between sum of left and right PFL activity determines steering command

$$\begin{aligned} d\theta/dt &\propto \text{DNa02R} - \text{DNa02L} + \epsilon \\ &= f(\sum W_{\text{D2R}, \text{P3R}_j} \times \text{P3R}_j + \sum W_{\text{D2}, \text{D3}} \times \text{D3R}) \\ &\quad - f(\sum W_{\text{D2L}, \text{P3L}_j} \times \text{P3L}_j + \sum W_{\text{D2}, \text{D3}} \times \text{D3L}) + \epsilon \end{aligned}$$



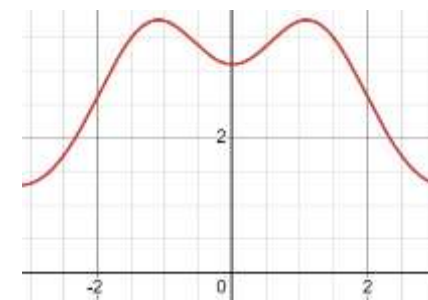
Modifications for two goals

- Heading direction and goal direction as bump of neural activity

$$g_{\text{heading}}(\phi, \theta) = \exp(\kappa_{\text{heading}} \cos(\theta - \phi)) \quad g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta) = \exp(\kappa_{\text{goal}} \cos(\delta - \phi)) + \exp(\kappa_{\text{goal}} \cos(-\delta - \phi))$$

- PFL3 neurons sum heading and goal input

$$\begin{aligned} h_{PFL3L}(\theta, \phi, \delta) &= S \cdot g_{\text{heading}}(\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}, \theta) + A \cdot g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta) \\ &= S \cdot \exp(\kappa_{\text{heading}} \cos(\theta - (\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}))) \\ &\quad + A \cdot (\exp(\kappa_{\text{goal}} \cos(\delta - \phi)) + \exp(\kappa_{\text{goal}} \cos(-\delta - \phi))) \end{aligned}$$



- Difference between sum of left and right PFL activity determines steering

$$\begin{aligned} G_{PFL3L}(\theta, \delta) &= \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} h_{PFL3L}(\theta, \phi, \delta)^2 d\phi \\ &= \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} (S \cdot g_{\text{heading}}(\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}, \theta) + A \cdot g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta))^2 d\phi \\ &= \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} [S^2 \cdot g_{\text{heading}}(\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}, \theta)^2 + A^2 \cdot g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta)^2 \\ &\quad + 2SA \cdot g_{\text{heading}}(\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}, \theta) \cdot g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta)] d\phi \end{aligned}$$



Derivation of the Reduced System

$$\begin{aligned}
 G_{PFL3L}(\theta, \delta) &= \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} h_{PFL3}(\theta, \phi, \delta)^2 d\phi \\
 &= \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} (S \cdot g_{\text{heading}}(\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}, \theta) + A \cdot g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta))^2 d\phi \\
 &= \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} [S^2 \cdot g_{\text{heading}}(\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}, \theta)^2 + A^2 \cdot g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta)^2 \\
 &\quad + 2SA \cdot g_{\text{heading}}(\phi - \Delta_{PFL3}, \theta) \cdot g_{\text{goal}}(\phi, \delta)] d\phi
 \end{aligned}$$

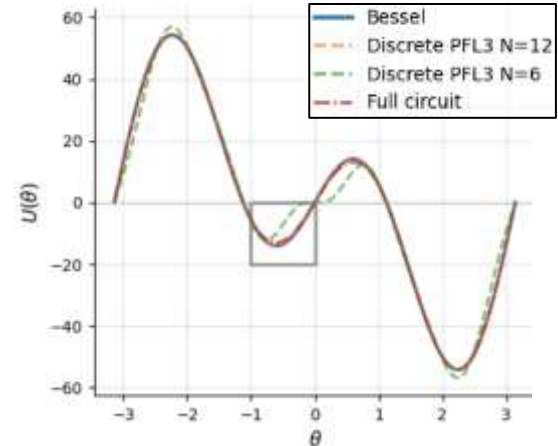
Let $\xi_{\phi}(a, b) : S^1 \times S^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{R} = \exp(\kappa_{\text{heading}} \cos(a - \phi) + \kappa_{\text{goal}} \cos(b - \phi))$, we can rewrite the above as:

$$\begin{aligned}
 G_{PFL3L}(\theta, \delta) - G_{PFL3R}(\theta, \delta) &= 2SA \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} (\xi_{\phi}(\theta + \Delta_{PFL3}, \delta) + \xi_{\phi}(\theta + \Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta) \\
 &\quad - \xi_{\phi}(\theta - \Delta_{PFL3}, \delta) - \xi_{\phi}(\theta - \Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta)) d\phi
 \end{aligned} \tag{7}$$



Thanks to the phasor sum & Bessel function

$$\begin{aligned}
 G_{PFL3L}(\theta, \delta) - G_{PFL3R}(\theta, \delta) &= 4\pi SA (I_0(\kappa(\theta + \Delta_{PFL3}, \delta)) + I_0(\kappa(\theta + \Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta)) \\
 &\quad - I_0(\kappa(\theta - \Delta_{PFL3}, \delta)) - I_0(\kappa(\theta - \Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta)))
 \end{aligned}$$





Taylor Expansion Approximation

$$G_{PFL3L}(\theta, \delta) - G_{PFL3R}(\theta, \delta) = 4\pi SA (I_0(\kappa(\theta + \Delta_{PFL3}, \delta)) + I_0(\kappa(\theta + \Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta)) \\ - I_0(\kappa(\theta - \Delta_{PFL3}, \delta)) - I_0(\kappa(\theta - \Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta)))$$

$$U(\theta, \delta) \approx U'(0, \delta) \theta + \frac{1}{6} U'''(0, \delta) \theta^3 + O(\theta^5). \quad \rightarrow \text{Thanks to symmetric property of kappa}$$

$$U'(0, \delta) = -8\pi SA \kappa_h \kappa_g \left[\frac{I_1(\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, \delta))}{\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, \delta)} \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} - \delta) + \frac{I_1(\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta))}{\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta)} \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} + \delta) \right]$$

$$U'''(0, \delta) = 8\pi SA \kappa_h \kappa_g [\sin(\Delta_{PFL3} - \delta) \cdot D(\kappa_-, C_-, S_-) + \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} + \delta) \cdot D(\kappa_+, C_+, S_+)]$$

with

$$D(K, C, S) = \frac{1}{K} \left[I_1(K) \left(1 - \frac{3C}{K^2} - \frac{3S^2}{K^4} \right) + \frac{3(I_0(K) + I_2(K))}{2} \left(\frac{C}{K} + \frac{S^2}{K^3} \right) - \frac{3I_1(K) + I_3(K)}{4} \cdot \frac{S}{K} \right]$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} \kappa_- &\equiv \kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, \delta) = \sqrt{\kappa_h^2 + \kappa_g^2 + 2\kappa_h \kappa_g \cos(\Delta_{PFL3} - \delta)} \\ \kappa_+ &\equiv \kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta) = \sqrt{\kappa_h^2 + \kappa_g^2 + 2\kappa_h \kappa_g \cos(\Delta_{PFL3} + \delta)} \\ C_- &\equiv \kappa_h \kappa_g \cos(\Delta_{PFL3} - \delta), & C_+ &\equiv \kappa_h \kappa_g \cos(\Delta_{PFL3} + \delta) \\ S_- &\equiv \kappa_h \kappa_g \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} - \delta), & S_+ &\equiv \kappa_h \kappa_g \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} + \delta) \end{aligned}$$

Body Mechanics and Second-Order System

$$\dot{\theta} = U(\theta, \delta) \approx A(\delta) \theta - B(\delta) \theta^3 + O(\theta^5), \text{ with}$$

$$A(\delta) \equiv U'(0, \delta), \quad B(\delta) \equiv -\frac{1}{6} U'''(0, \delta).$$

$$U'(0, \delta) = -8\pi S A \kappa_h \kappa_g \left[\frac{I_1(\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, \delta))}{\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, \delta)} \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} - \delta) + \frac{I_1(\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta))}{\kappa(\Delta_{PFL3}, -\delta)} \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} + \delta) \right]$$

$$U'''(0, \delta) = 8\pi S A \kappa_h \kappa_g [\sin(\Delta_{PFL3} - \delta) \cdot D(\kappa_-, C_-, S_-) + \sin(\Delta_{PFL3} + \delta) \cdot D(\kappa_+, C_+, S_+)]$$

Angular velocity command



Overdamping $I \rightarrow 0$

Torque command

$$I\ddot{\theta} + c\dot{\theta} = A(\delta, \kappa) \theta - B(\delta, \kappa) \theta^3$$

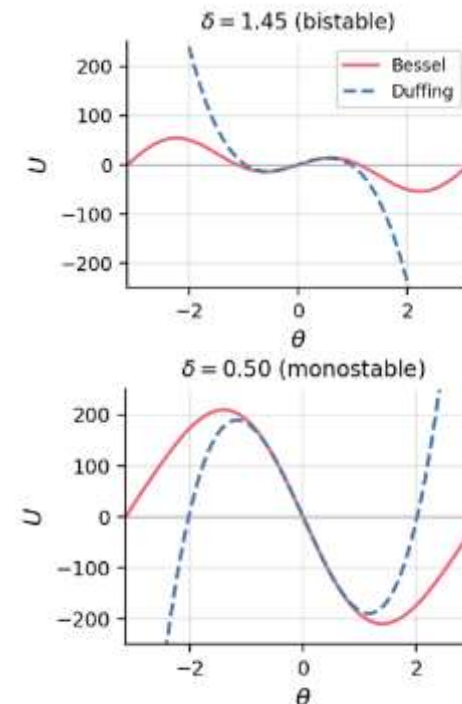
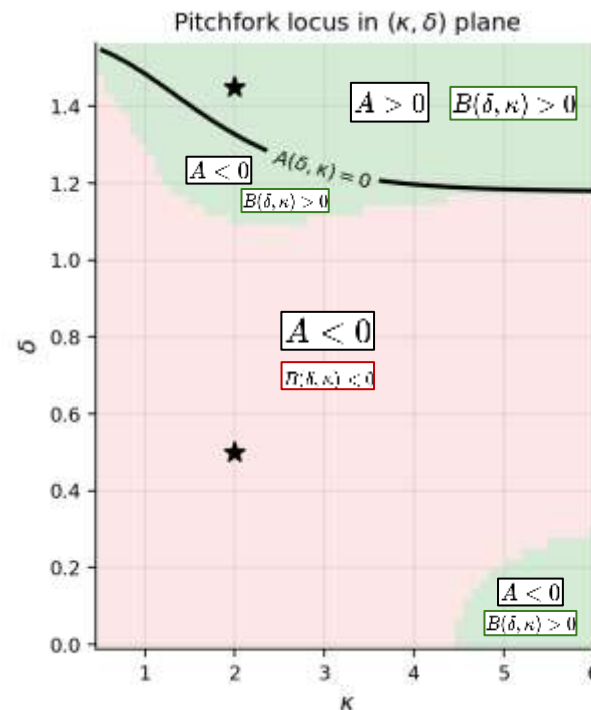


Double-well Energy Landscape

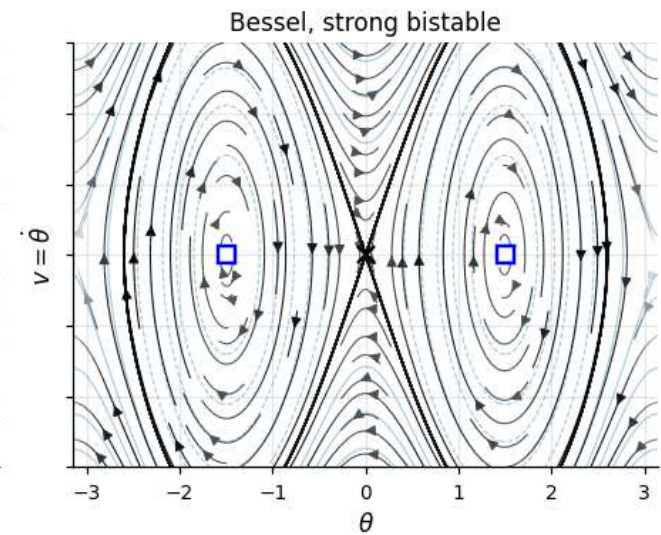
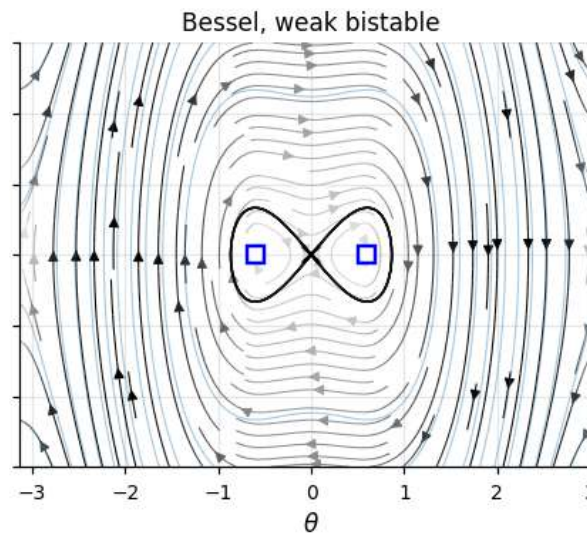
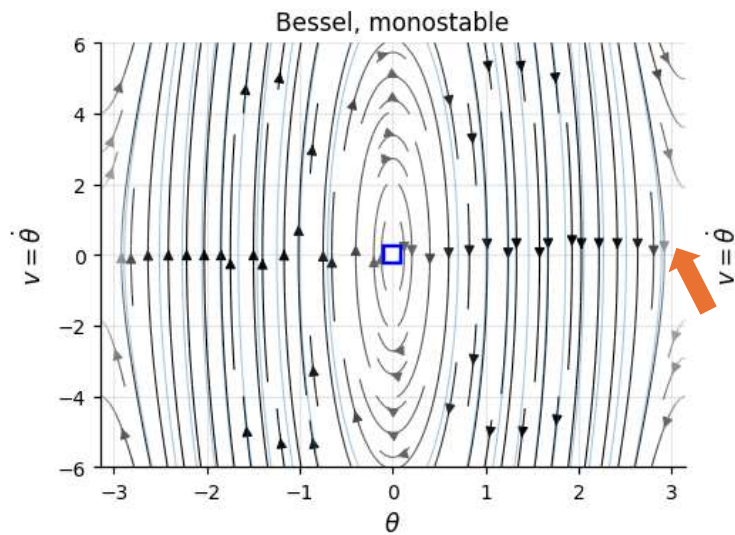
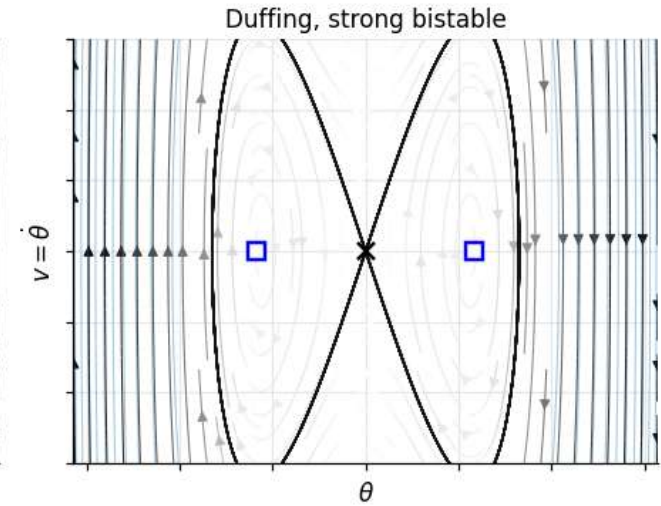
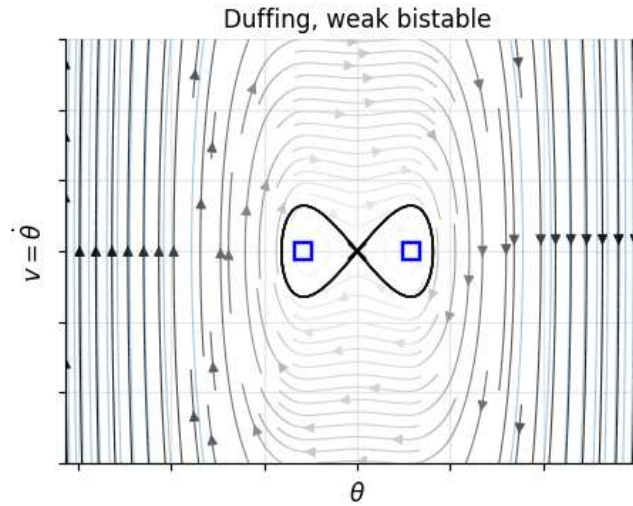
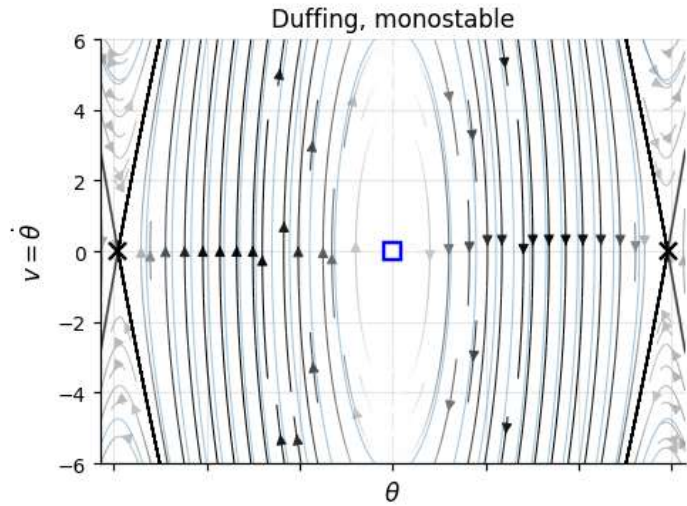
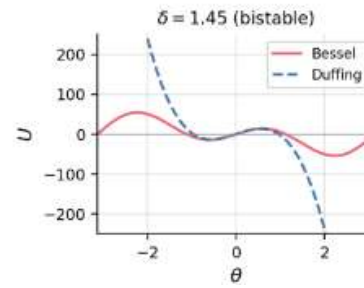
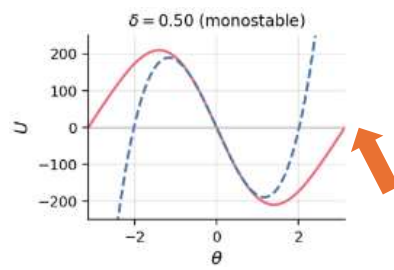
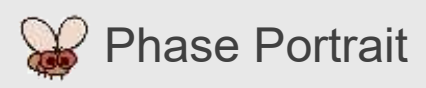
$$I\ddot{\theta} + \gamma\dot{\theta} = A(\delta, \kappa)\theta - B(\delta, \kappa)\theta^3$$

Linearize at the origin, $\dot{\theta} = A\theta$, so the fixed point at $\theta = 0$ is **unstable** iff. $A(\delta, \kappa) = U'(0, \delta) > 0$

When in addition $B(\delta, \kappa) > 0$ (i.e. $U'''(0, \delta) < 0$), two new equilibria emerge at $\theta = \pm\sqrt{\frac{A}{B}}$



Kappa = 2
Delta = 1, 1.36, 1.55



$A < 0$ $B(\delta, \kappa) < 0$

$A > 0$ $B(\delta, \kappa) > 0$

Homoclinic Orbits

$$H(\theta, v) = \frac{1}{2}v^2 - \frac{1}{2}A\theta^2 + \frac{1}{4}B\theta^4, \quad v \equiv \dot{\theta}.$$
$$= 0$$



$$\theta_0(t) = \sqrt{\frac{2A}{B}} \operatorname{sech}(\sqrt{A}t), \quad v_0(t) = -\sqrt{\frac{2A}{B}} \sqrt{A} \operatorname{sech}(\sqrt{A}t) \tanh(\sqrt{A}t).$$



Melnikov's Method

$$\dot{\theta} = v, \quad \dot{v} = A\theta - B\theta^3 + \epsilon[-\gamma v + F \cos \omega t],$$

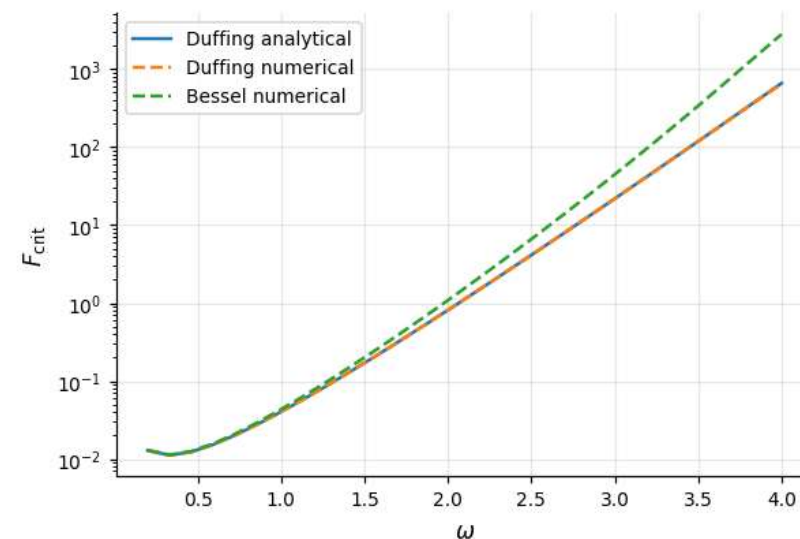
$$\begin{aligned} M(t_0) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \nabla H(\gamma_0(\tau)) \cdot \mathbf{g}(\gamma_0(\tau), \tau + t_0) d\tau \\ &= -\frac{4\gamma A^{3/2}}{3B} - F\pi\omega \sqrt{\frac{2}{B}} \operatorname{sech}\left(\frac{\pi\omega}{2\sqrt{A}}\right) \sin \omega t_0 \\ &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$F_{\text{crit}}(\omega) = \frac{4\gamma A}{3\pi\omega\sqrt{2B}} \cosh\left(\frac{\pi\omega}{2\sqrt{A}}\right).$$

$$\mathbf{g} = (0, -\gamma v + F \cos \omega t)^T$$

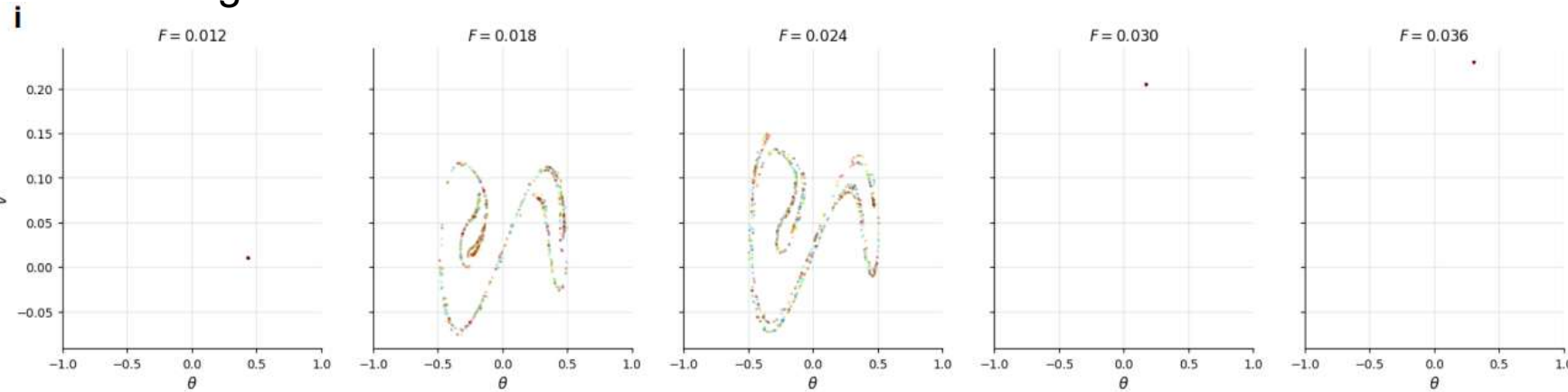
$$\gamma_0 = (\theta_0, v_0)^T$$

$$H(\theta, v) = \frac{1}{2}v^2 - \frac{1}{2}A\theta^2 + \frac{1}{4}B\theta^4, \quad v \equiv \dot{\theta}.$$

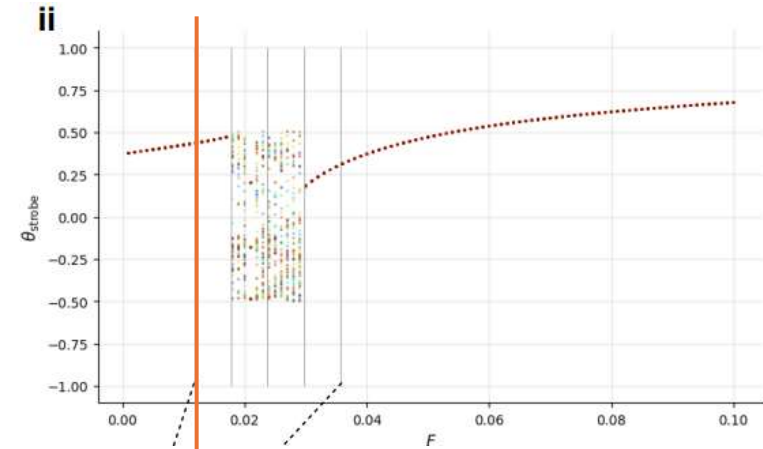


Numerical Validations – Vary Forcing Amplitude

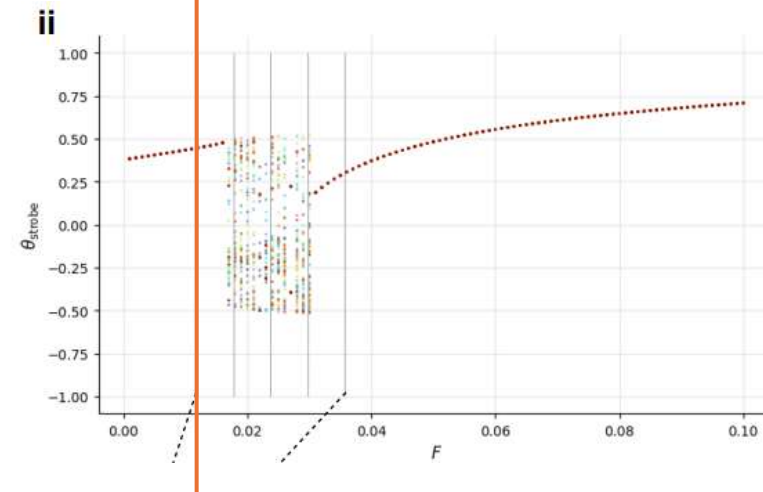
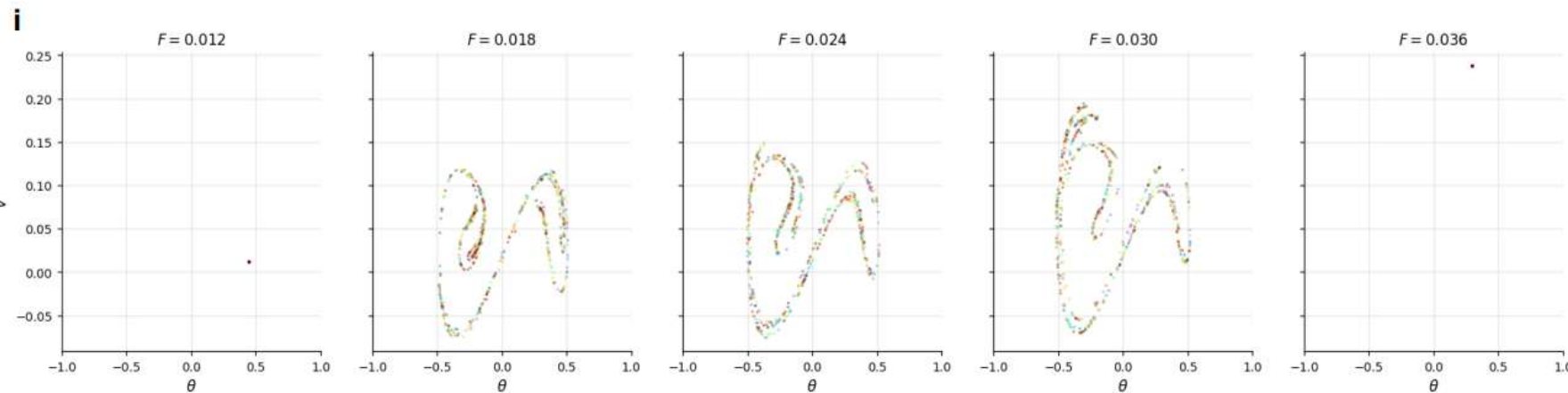
Duffing



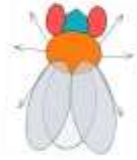
F_{critical}



12 PFL3 Neurons



$F = 0.0190$ $\omega = 0.421$ $\epsilon = 100.00$ $\eta = 0.00100$

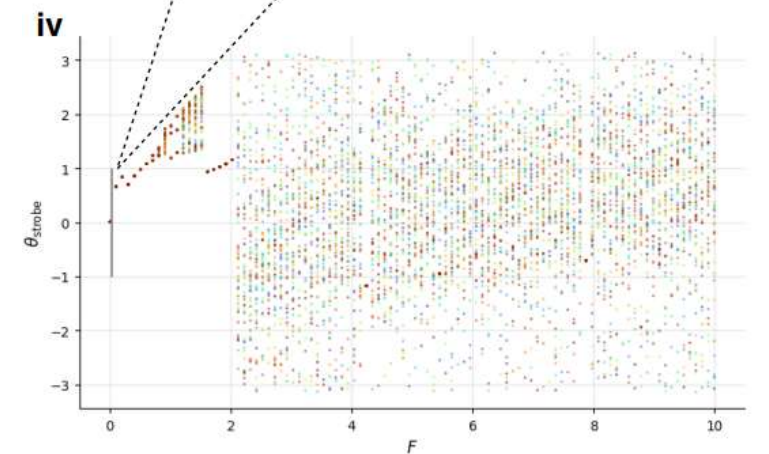
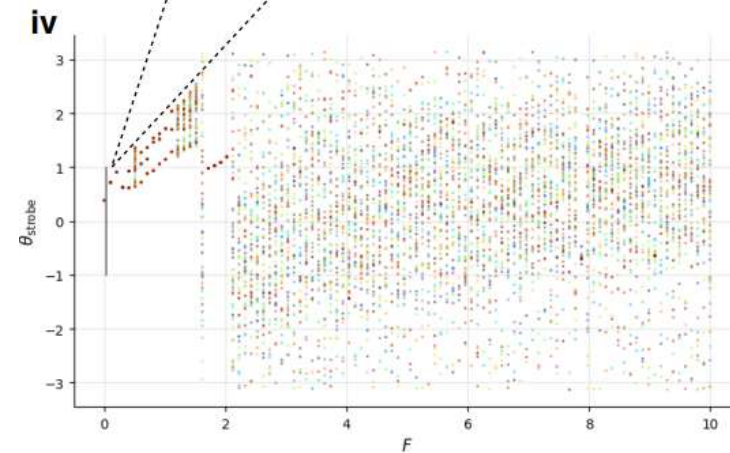
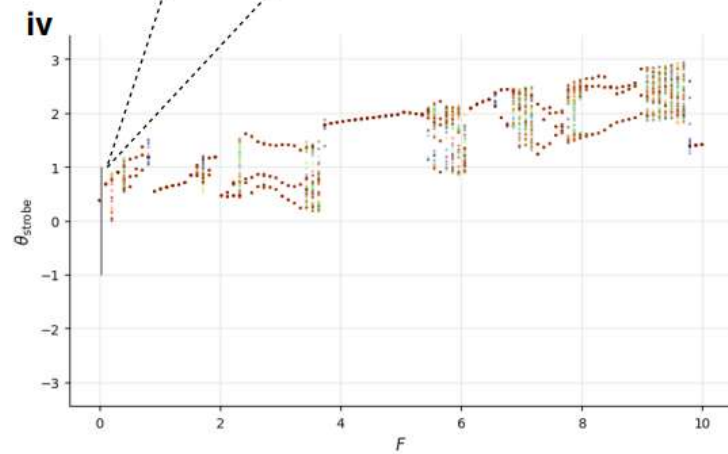
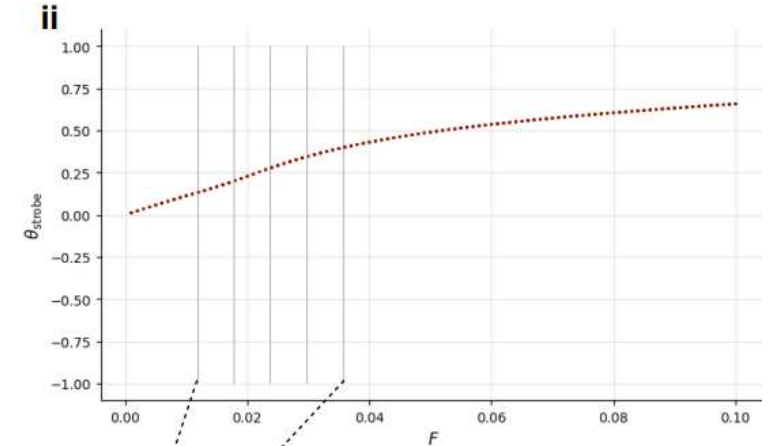
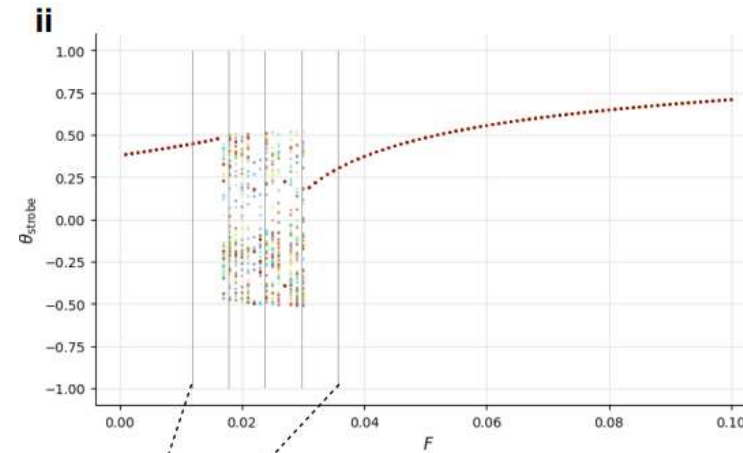
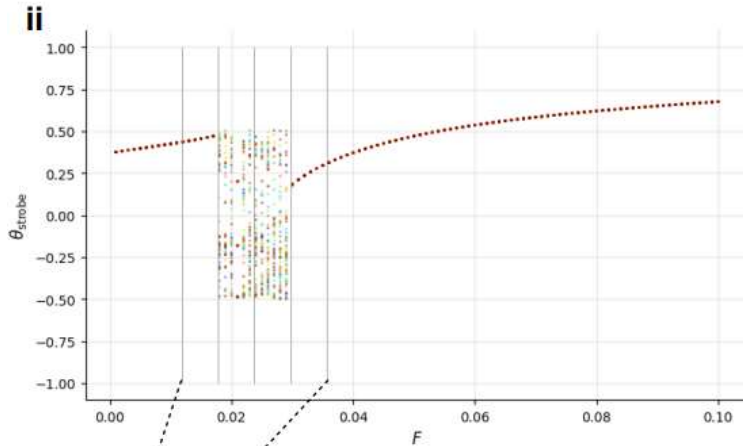


Numerical Validations

Duffing

12 PFL3
Neurons

6 PFL3
Neurons

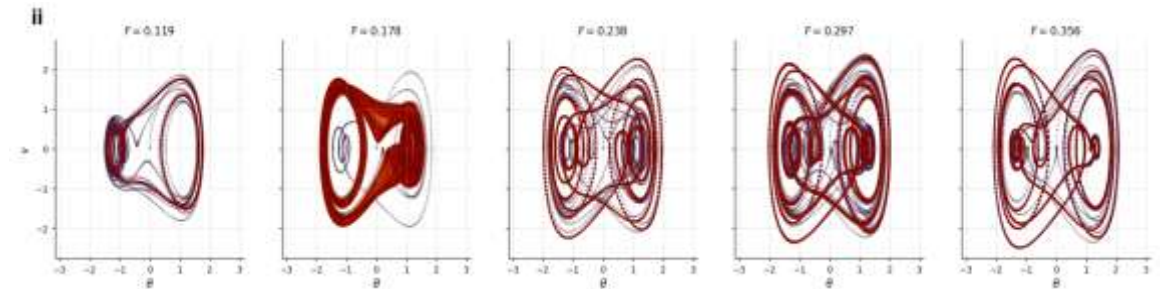
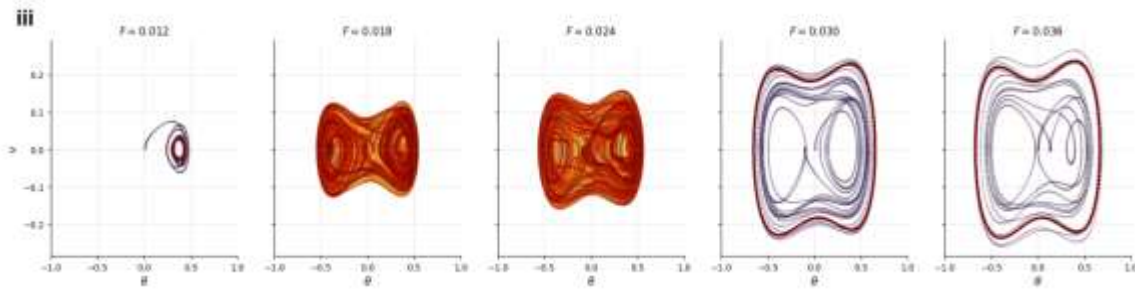


Numerical Validations

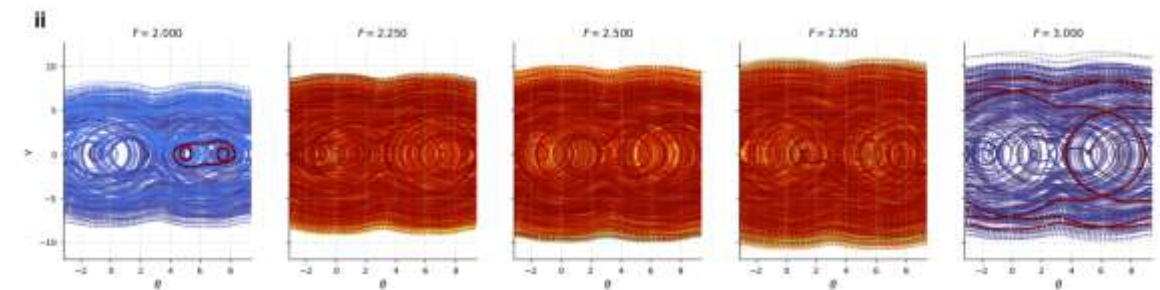
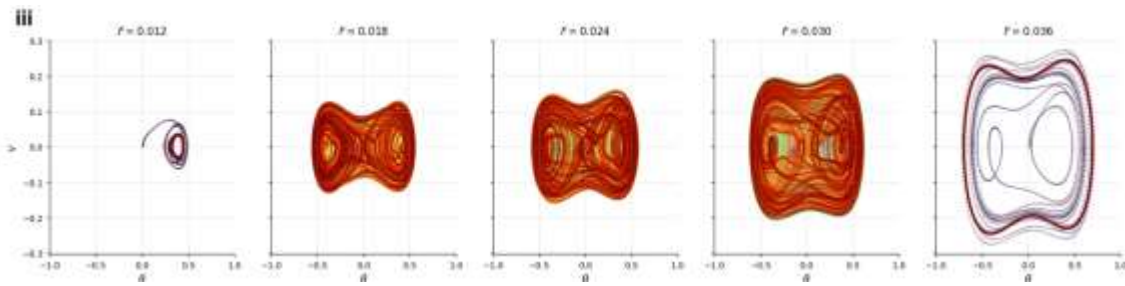
$F = 0.012 - 0.036$

$F = 2 - 3$

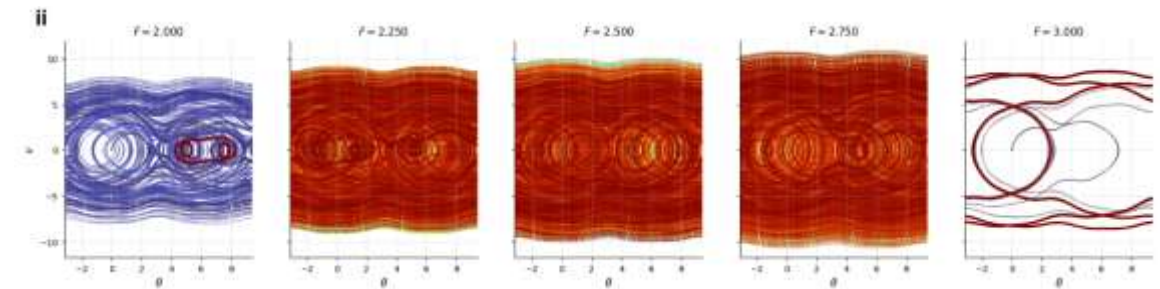
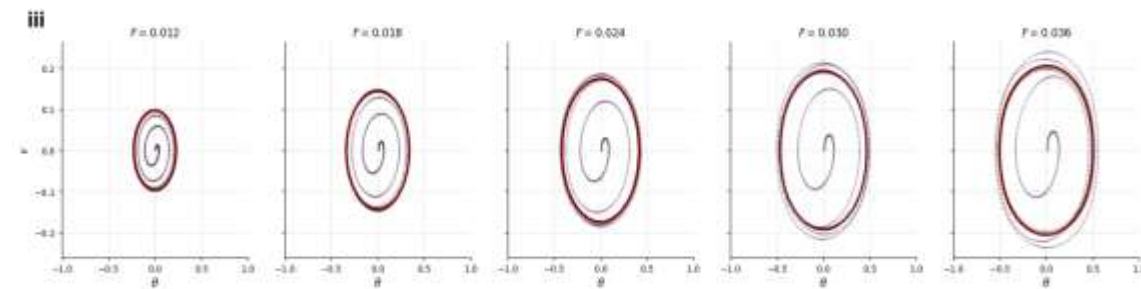
Duffing



12 PFL3
Neurons



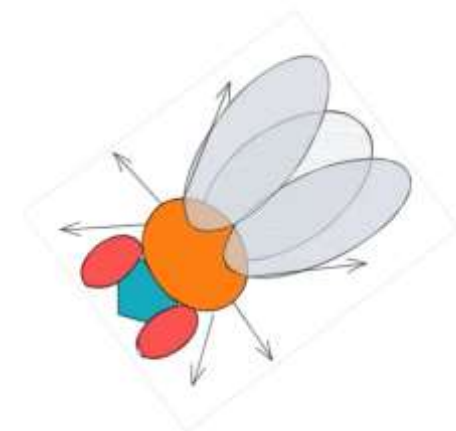
6 PFL3
Neurons



Summary

- The neural circuit model under dual goal condition has a double-well potential
- We connected it to the Duffing equation using Taylor expansion
- We analyzed the bifurcation conditions
- We derived the homoclinic orbit and solved for the conditions for chaos
- We made cartoons when the fly goes nuts

$F = 2.5000$ $\omega = 0.425$ $t = 60.00 \text{ s}$ $\theta = +2.21 \text{ rad}$



Thank you!